Week 2: Group Activity Worksheet

Shape Stories — Triangle, Rectangle, Circle

Tutorial Objective: Understand the visual and emotional character of the three basic shapes. Then use **only** those shapes to tell a story that the audience can follow without words.

Links to Subject Outcomes: Identify the nature of visual elements; apply visual elements and design principles in expressive narration; apply basic semiotics (shapes as signs).

Keep everything from today. In Week 6 you will continue this story as a stop motion animation.

How This Tutorial Runs

Activity	Mode
Briefing: shapes as visual language	Whole class
Part A – Shape characteristics study and thumbnails	Individual
Part B – Cast your shape characters	Individual
Part C – Write and draw the shape story (storyboard)	Individual
Part D – Present in class with peer feedback	Groups → class
Part E – Reflection and Blackboard upload	Individual

Materials Checklist

☐ A3 or A4 drawing paper (at least 2 sheets)
☐ Black marker / fineliner, pencil, eraser, ruler, compass or round template
☐ Coloured paper and scissors (optional: cut-out shapes)
☐ **One** accent colour marker (optional, see story rules)
☐ Phone or scanner to capture your work
☐ Your Visual Journal

Student Information

Field	Details
English Full Name	
Student ID	
Tutorial Class	
Presentation Group	
Date	

Part A: Characteristics of Basic Shapes

A.1 Shape Analysis Table

Describe each shape in your own words. Think about edges, angles, how it sits on a surface and how it makes you feel.

Characteristic	Triangle △	Rectangle ▭	Circle ○
Edges & corners *(sharp / straight / none)*			
Stability *(stable / unstable / rolling)*			
Direction / movement it suggests			
Visual weight *(heavy / light, where)*			
Emotions it suggests *(3 words)*			

A.1 Shape Analysis Table *(continued)*

Characteristic	Triangle △	Rectangle ▭	Circle ○
Personality if it were a person			
Symbolic / cultural meaning *(e.g. warning sign, frame, sun, unity)*			
3 real-world examples *(logos, signs, buildings, objects)*			
How meaning changes when rotated			
How meaning changes when scaled / repeated			

Hint: an upright triangle feels stable or like a mountain; an inverted triangle feels tense. A square standing on its corner feels unstable. Test this in A.2.

A.2 Thumbnail Experiments

Draw **3 small thumbnails per shape** in the boxes below. In each, change **one** thing only (orientation, size, position, repetition or grouping) and write the feeling it creates underneath.

Triangle

Thumbnail 1	Thumbnail 2	Thumbnail 3
Change: _____ Feeling: _____	Change: _____ Feeling: _____	Change: _____ Feeling: _____

Rectangle

Thumbnail 1	Thumbnail 2	Thumbnail 3
Change: _____ Feeling: _____	Change: _____ Feeling: _____	Change: _____ Feeling: _____

A.2 Thumbnail Experiments *(continued)*

Circle

Thumbnail 1	Thumbnail 2	Thumbnail 3
Change: _____ Feeling: _____	Change: _____ Feeling: _____	Change: _____ Feeling: _____

Shape Relationships

Draw **two shapes together** and describe the relationship (e.g. a circle trapped inside a rectangle = confinement).

Combination	Sketch	Relationship / Meaning
△ + ○		
▭ + ○		
△ + ▭		

Part B: Cast Your Shape Characters

Use your findings from Part A. Each character's personality must come from the shape's characteristics, not random choice.

Role	Shape (type, size, colour)	Personality (3 words)	Why this shape fits (link to Part A)
Main character			
Opponent / obstacle			
Helper / friend *(optional)*			
Setting / world *(e.g. rectangles as buildings)*			

Character sketch sheet: draw each character in two poses or emotional states (e.g. happy / afraid) using only rotation, scale and position.

Part C: Write and Draw the Story

C.1 Story Rules

1. Use **only triangles, rectangles and circles**. You may scale, rotate, repeat, overlap and group them.
2. **No words inside the panels.** Only a title is allowed.
3. Black and white, plus **one** optional accent colour to show emphasis.
4. **6 to 9 panels**, with a clear beginning, conflict, climax and ending.
5. The audience should understand the story **without your explanation**.

C.2 Story Plan

Story Title:

One-sentence logline *(e.g. "A lonely circle rolls through a city of rectangles looking for a place to fit in.")*

Story Stage	What Happens	Main Emotion
Beginning *(introduce character & world)*		
Conflict *(problem or obstacle appears)*		
Climax *(most intense moment)*		
Ending *(resolution or twist)*		

C.3 Panel Breakdown

Plan each panel before you draw. Name the **design principle** each panel uses: movement, balance, emphasis or unity.

Panel	What Happens	Shapes Used	Design Principle	How the Principle Is Shown
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				
9				

C.4 Storyboard

Draw your final storyboard on A3 paper (recommended) or in the frames below. Number every panel.

Part D: Class Presentation

D.1 Presentation Structure (2 minutes per student)

Step	What to Do
1. **Silent viewing**	Show your storyboard. Do **not** speak. Let the audience guess the story.
2. **Audience guess**	One or two classmates say what they think happens.
3. **Your explanation**	Explain your characters, which shape characteristics you used and why.
4. **Q&A**	Answer one question.

My presentation notes:

D.2 Peer Feedback I Received

Ask two classmates to fill in one row each.

Reviewer Name	Did you understand the story without words? *(Yes / Partly / No)*	Strongest panel & why	One suggestion

D.3 Peer Feedback I Gave

Presenter Name	Their story in one sentence (my guess)	Strongest panel	One suggestion

Part E: Reflection

Which shape was the hardest to give emotion to? How did you solve it?

Did the audience read your story as you intended? What caused any misunderstanding?

What would you change before turning this story into an animation in Week 6? *(movement, extra scenes, ending)*

Blackboard Submission

Upload Checklist

☐ Completed shape analysis table (A.1) and thumbnails (A.2)
☐ Character sheet (Part B)
☐ Story plan and panel breakdown (C.2, C.3)
☐ **Final storyboard**, scanned or photographed flat, in good light and readable
☐ Peer feedback received (D.2) and reflection (Part E)

File Requirements

Item	Requirement
Format	One combined PDF (storyboard page at full resolution)
File Name	`W02_[EnglishFullName]_[StudentNumber].pdf`
Location	Blackboard → SSHD2382 → Week 2 → Shape Story
Deadline	Before the start of the Week 3 tutorial

Keep your original paper storyboard and characters. You will need them in Week 6.

Additional Notes

References & Resources

Use this space to record any references consulted (shape logos, signs or artworks that inspired you):